

RYAN MARX

DESIGNER • DEVELOPER



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Hello. My name is Ryan. Nice to meet you.

I'm a designer, developer, and problem solver with years of telling stories. I live in the Chicago area but have worked with newsrooms from New York to Arizona.

I use visualization, development, UX design, writing, and editing to dig past surface-level asks and distill mountains of information into meaningful, empowering experiences.

It's all communication.

We humans are natural storytellers and respond well when we find reflections of ourselves in the tales and experiences of others. But, it doesn't stop there.

A good user experience tells a story, too. People encounter interfaces in their own way, and we all need help making sense of things. That's the work.

What I do

I thrive in collaborative and cross-functional capacities, helping disparate teams communicate and collaborate on shared goals. Whether I'm designing, developing, or participating in some other way, I bring a human-focused approach, keeping everyone's eyes on the final product. This requires speaking technology with content creators and content creation with technologists, cutting through friction so work moves forward without bottlenecks.

Throughout the years I've made it all: featured interactives, standalone presentations, and dashboard user interfaces. Each format has its place, and choosing the right one for the job is a delicate, practical art. The goal is always to build lean solutions that don't sacrifice quality for speed — or speed for quality.

HTML, CSS, and TypeScript are my bread and butter. I love to ship with Svelte, Vue, or even plain vanilla. I've worked with D3, Node, and mapping tools (Leaflet, MapBox, etc.).

Also ...

When I'm not telling stories, you'll find me entertaining one of my many inner nerds: science fiction, theater, cooking, and youth softball (as a proud softball dad). And, finally (perhaps most importantly), I believe there isn't anything that can't be made better with a cup of hot coffee. Or two.

Let's talk. I look forward to hearing from you. 😊

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PROFILE

I've spent my career helping tell stories and communicate information with visuals, data and enriching interactive experiences. I help to find the important messages and express them in the best ways possible. Sometimes all it takes is a few carefully chosen words. More often, however, the effort involves distilling mountains of information into meaningful and enjoyable experiences.

SKILLS

FRONTEND WEB

HTML/CSS/Typescript

Web accessibility and semantic design (helps with SEO, too).

Frameworks are not essential, but my favorite is SvelteJS. I also can do Vue and React.

BACKEND

Node, Go, Python

DESIGN

Adobe Illustrator (especially for SVGs, Figma

EXPERIENCE

FRONT-END ENGINEER

PULSAR INFORATICS, 2023 - CURRENT

As a member of a small, cross-functional team, I work closely with designers and product leaders to develop a refined user experience for our centerpiece software. My focus is on the web-based console that includes elements data management and visualization.

FULL-STACK DEVELOPER

GANNETT STORYTELLING STUDIO, 2018 - 2023

My team and I collaborated with newsrooms across the company to create top-notch storytelling by developing tools, frameworks and custom experiences. We used an agile, human-centered approach to iteratively test hypotheses about reader behavior and refine our goals. We built tools to achieve a facility on our company's infrastructure and a collaboration of technologies that wouldn't otherwise exist.

ASSISTANT DATA VISUALIZATION EDITOR

CHICAGO TRIBUNE, 2013 - 2018

I helped coordinate the efforts of all graphic reporters and artists across long- and short-term projects while leading our transformation into a digital-focused team. I helped develop technology stacks, templates and best practices for everything from static graphics to fully composed articles and interactives. Though the graphics team was full of expert artists and journalists, our digital abilities were minimal. For our transformation to succeed, the plan needed to include everyone and, thus, a key responsibility for me was to serve as a coach/mentor to help us all contribute to our digital growth.

BUSINESS GRAPHICS COORDINATOR

CHICAGO TRIBUNE, 2010 - 2013

GRAPHICS EDITOR

THE TIMES OF NORTHWEST INDIANA, 2009 - 2010

DESIGNER

THE TIMES OF NORTHWEST INDIANA, 2005 - 2009

PRESENTATION EDITOR, COPY EDITOR/DESIGNER

THE NEWS-ENTERPRISE, 2002 - 2005